

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a film magazine:

Why *Spirited Away* Changed Animation Forever

In 2001, one of the most celebrated anime movies hit theatres in Japan. Directed by Hayao Miyazaki and produced by Studio Ghibli, *Spirited Away* would leave a mark on animation in the 21st century.



The story follows an ordinary 10-year-old girl, Chihiro, as she arrives at a deserted theme park that turns into a world of spirits at night. Her parents are turned into pigs by Yubaba, the witch who manages a bathhouse serving otherworldly customers. Chihiro must work in the bathhouse to save her parents and find a way to return home. The story is a tale of resilience, as Chihiro gradually finds her inner strength.

The movie arrived at a time when people thought animation was for children. *Spirited Away* destroyed prejudice about the art form and proved that a movie created in Japanese with elements of Japanese folklore could reach global audiences of all ages.

Jane Napier, a film critic, underlines the global impact of the movie. The movie's theme is uncertainty. "I think this is one reason why this movie is so popular; it recognizes that the world can be scary, and that we don't always know what's going to happen to us," Napier explains.

To Yoshioka, a Studio Ghibli fan, *Spirited Away* can be interpreted in numerous ways by the viewer. "This is key for the film to be loved as a classic," he says. "So, even 20 years on, *Spirited Away* is a movie that can be watched and rewatched."

You are members of the School Movie Society. You have been asked to plan a Movie Festival at your school. You may want to talk about:

- whether anime movies would be suitable for the festival
- other types of movies that are popular among secondary school students
- other activities to organise for the festival
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like anime movies?
2. What is your favourite animated movie?
3. Do you prefer animated or live-action movies?
4. Do you think that anime movies can be for adults?
5. Should all anime movies have a happy ending?
6. What type of movies make you want to watch them again?
7. What makes an anime movie appealing?
8. Do you agree anime movies have artistic value?